7H MUSIC GROUP · MUSIC BUSINESS CAPSTONE

BARANGA

12-Week Strategic Marketing Plan

Afro-pop / rap artist. Kampala street storytelling, melodic hooks, award-nominated debut album. This is the corrected strategy — rebuilt on the artist's actual recorded work, not an acoustic-guitar profile.

TERRITORY	TIMELINE	ARTIST	STATUS
Kampala → East Africa	**12 weeks / 3 phases**	**7H Music Group roster**	**Revised edition**

CORRECTION NOTICE · WHAT CHANGED AND WHY

The brief called him a guitarist. The catalogue says otherwise.

Baranga is an Afro-pop / rap artist. His recorded work, his label's own roster page and his award nominations all point the same way — so the strategy had to move with them.

ORIGINAL DOCUMENT SAID	CORRECTED POSITION	STRATEGIC CONSEQUENCE
“Soulful Afro-fusion singer, guitarist & songwriter”	Afro-pop / rap artist and songwriter; rapped verses, melodic hooks	Credibility now sits in lyricism, flow and street storytelling — not instrumental performance
Sonic signature: “warm acoustic guitar, organic percussion”	Street-storytelling rap over Afro-pop production, in-house by Mike 1ne	Content engine shifts to verses, freestyles and open-verse challenges instead of acoustic clips
“Release full EP in Week 9”	Debut album Chapters I Never Wrote is already out (Oct 2026)	Plan becomes a campaign extension: focus single, remix, deluxe, live — not a first release
Target: 150,000 cumulative streams by Week 12	“Badman” alone has passed 290,000 streams and reached the Ugandan Top 100	Target raised to 450,000 incremental streams across the 12-week window
Competitor set included Tungi (a collaborator)	Peer set: Joshua Baraka, Azawi, Fik Fameica, Senté	Collabs are treated as reach assets; only non-collaborators are competitors
Visual anchor: linen outerwear + acoustic guitar strap	Street-luxe earth tones, layered workwear, beaded wristpiece, Kampala backdrops	Shoot list and merch line redesigned around the actual visual language

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

From one breakout record to a defensible Kampala rap career.

“Badman” proved the market exists. Two UG Hip Hop Awards 2026 nominations — Rookie of the Year and Album of the Year — prove the industry noticed. The next twelve weeks convert that momentum into a repeatable career: a focus single that travels beyond Kampala, a fan base the label owns directly, and revenue that does not depend entirely on streaming pennies.

Three moves define the plan: own the street-storytelling lane instead of chasing radio pop; turn award-season attention into owned audience; and monetise through merch, live and brand partnerships while streams compound.

290K+ streams on “Badman”

2 UG Hip Hop Awards 2026 nominations

#1 Ugandan Top 100 chart entry

12 weeks, 3 phases, 1 focus single

Recommended strategy: build a new ladder — “Kampala Street Storytelling & Afro-Pop Crossover” — rather than climb the commercial Afro-pop ladder against better-funded incumbents.

SECTION 1 · THE FACT BASE WE ARE PLANNING FROM

What the catalogue actually shows

Every target in this plan is set against recorded output and verified placements — not aspiration.

ALBUM · 2026

Chapters I Never Wrote

- Debut full-length, 8 October 2026 — seven tracks
- Produced and mixed in-house by Mike 1ne

SINGLE · 2025

“Badman” ft. Stando & Andrinah

- 290,000+ streams; Ugandan Top 100 entry
- Listed work for the Rookie of the Year nomination

UG HIP HOP AWARDS 2026

Awards season

- Album of the Year nominee — the debut album
- Rookie of the Year nominee — “Badman”

STREAMING

Catalogue to draw on

- SALO · Do you? · Confirm · Party Riddim
- Chapters I Never Wrote (2026) · features with Smokie Cee and King Avo

REACH ASSETS

Collaboration network

- Smokie Cee, Mr Fallback, Tungi, King Avo
- “Island Kiss” and “Motion” extend reach through 2026

OPERATIONS

Structural advantage

- In-house production: speed and cost control
- Four-artist roster makes features and remixes cheap

Who is Baranga?

ARTIST IDENTITY Afro-pop / rap artist and songwriter from Kampala — rapped street narratives, melodic hooks, Luganda and English.

THE PROMISE

End-benefit: “Seen & Heard”

- Fans hear their own city, hustle and heartbreak told back to them with confidence.

SOUND

Sonic signature

- Punchy Afro-pop drums under rap verses; sung hooks; in-house 7H production.

CONTENT

Lyric territory

- Ambition, loyalty, street survival, young love — named places, not generic romance.

Why the old framing cost us

- “Guitarist” framed him against acoustic acts he has never released with
- It invited comparison with artists built for live acoustic sets
- It buried the differentiator: rap lyricism and street detail

What the new framing unlocks

- Entry into rap and Afro-pop playlists, award categories, freestyle culture
- A native content format: verses, open-verse challenges, cyphers
- Pricing power for features, brand work and live bookings

Four objectives, benchmarked to the current base

01

STREAMING REACH

450,000

incremental streams across Spotify, Apple Music and Audiomack in 12 weeks — on top of the 290K+ already banked by "Badman". Roughly US$1,500–1,800 in campaign royalties.

02

OWNED FAN BASE

3,000

members in a direct channel (WhatsApp channel + Telegram) with at least 25% monthly active engagement; 1,000 opted-in phone numbers for drop alerts.

03

RADIO & MEDIA

30 DJs, 4 stations

rotation secured for the focus single's clean edit, plus two live in-studio performances; six interview or feature placements online and on TV.

04

MERCH & LIVE

US$3,450

gross: 150 merch units at UGX 55,000 (~US$15) and 120 tickets at UGX 38,000 (~US$10) for one headline showcase.

Baseline discipline

Every target is incremental to a Week 0 snapshot of streams, followers and listeners.

How the objectives ladder up

- Streams fund visibility → visibility fills the owned channel → the owned channel sells merch and tickets → revenue funds the next release cycle.

SECTION 4 · AUDIENCE PROFILE

Who we are actually talking to

PRIMARY AUDIENCE

Core: Kampala hip-hop heads (18–28)

- Students, boda riders, campus and streetwear crowds in Kawempe, Bwaise, Ntinda, Kamwokya
- Follow rap beefs, cyphers and DJ sets; trust bars over polish
- Discover on TikTok and YouTube, then stream on Audiomack and Spotify

GROWTH AUDIENCE

Diaspora and East African region

- Ugandans in Nairobi, Dar es Salaam, Kigali, Johannesburg and the UK
- High-value streamers and ticket buyers for future touring
- Reached through remixes, regional features and community pages

SECONDARY AUDIENCE

Adjacent: Afro-pop listeners (18–32)

- Kololo, Bugolobi, Ntinda young professionals and diaspora
- Arrive through hooks and features, stay for the catalogue
- Playlist-led: Spotify, Apple Music, radio drive-time

MOTIVATION

What they crave

- Authenticity they can verify — places, slang, real prices
- Access: verses before release, private listening
- Momentum: backing someone early, before the mainstream

Creator first. Everyman underneath.

Creator PRIMARY

Builds worlds from his own experience: writes, records and releases at speed through in-house production. Speaks in craft, catalogue and process.

Everyma SECONDARY

The Kawempe kid who made it without leaving the neighbourhood behind. Speaks in belonging, shared struggle and local pride.

Visual system

- Palette: asphalt black, gold, dusty tan, faded camo green, terracotta accent
- Wardrobe: layered workwear over camo, gold chain, beaded wristpiece as the signature object
- Locations: Kampala streets, rooftops, workshops, night-market light — never a blank studio
- Type: compressed all-caps headlines that read like a poster pasted on a wall

Non-negotiable brand rules

- No acoustic-guitar imagery anywhere in the campaign — it misrepresents the music
- Every visual carries one recognisable Kampala location, named in the caption
- Face-forward: the artist's name should be legible at thumbnail size
- Lyrics are always on screen as text, never only as audio

Merch logic: the beaded wristpiece becomes the entry-price product; camp-cap and heavyweight tee carry the type system; a limited "Chapters" print run ties the drop to the album artwork.

SECTION 6 · COMPETITION — THE CLOSEST SOUND-ALIKES FIRST

Peers, then challengers

Tier 1 is the real contest: melodic Afro-pop / rap released into the same Kampala window.

	THEIR STRENGTH	THEIR WEAKNESS	HOW BARANGA EXPLOITS IT
Senté ALTÉ / HIP-HOP / R&B	Deeds calls him at the fore of East African alt-R&B; Spotify Fresh Finds Africa (2024)	Slow release cadence, niche live footprint, alté framing limits radio	Out-release him: five drops in twelve weeks, with harder Afro-pop hooks
Pryce Teeba HIP-HOP / AFROBEATS	UGHHA Male Rapper of the Year (2025); deep Luganda catalogue and mixtapes	Rap-first presentation and long project cycles; little crossover	Take the crossover lane: sung hooks, playlist-ready singles
Tungi AFROBEAT / URBAN	Genre-fluid singles, steady features; “Siteesa” with producer Mike 1ne	A collaborator — but he takes the same feature and playlist slots	Borrow his base first: joint release, then compete for the slot
Quency · ECEE · Tai Dai HIP-HOP · RAP · ALTÉ	Independent new-wave acts building on TikTok and Audiomack	Thin marketing budgets, inconsistent release discipline	Out-spend them: in-house production and a 12-week content drumbeat

Then the artists holding the doors he needs

Not sound-alikes — incumbents. Every one of them is beatable on a specific, named weakness.

COMPETITOR	STRENGTH	WEAKNESS	HOW BARANGA WINS
Joshua Baraka International Afro-pop	Regional hits, major playlists, MOBO-nominated, arena-scale live draw (B'RAKA LAND)	High-gloss production; little street-level detail	Trench detail and rap credibility in a lane he does not occupy
Azawi Commercial Afro-pop	Owns radio rotation and corporate sponsorship	Radio-pop formula; weak direct-to-fan ownership	An owned channel plus features-driven virality he cannot block
Fik Fameica Rap heavyweight	Decade-long rap brand and a huge live draw	Party-anthem brand; limited introspective writing	Lyric-led album craft that outlasts a club record
Elijah Kitaka R&B / Afro-pop	Smooth vocal crossover and strong corporate bookings	Inconsistent release schedule; light Luganda folk narrative	A disciplined twelve-week release ritual he does not run

Baranga's internal SWOT, read against those two tiers

S STRENGTHS

- 290K+ streams · Top 100 entry
- Two UGHHA nominations
- In-house production

W WEAKNESSES

- Shallow catalogue depth
- Kampala-concentrated awareness
- No owned fan data

O OPPORTUNITIES

- Award-season attention
- Remix and feature culture
- Brand partnership budget

T THREATS

- Playlist dependency
- Rap-genre pigeonholing
- Rival release volume

Do not climb their ladder. Build one.

EXISTING LADDER · COMMERCIAL AFRO-POP

Entry cost: big budgets, radio gatekeepers, gimmick hooks

1 **Joshua Baraka**

2 **Azawi**

3 **Fik Fameica**

... Baranga — chasing

NEW LADDER · KAMPALA STREET STORYTELLING

Entry cost: lyricism, consistency, owned audience

#1 BARANGA

First voice that sounds like the streets and still fills a radio hook

- Owned space: organic Kampala narrative rap with Afro-pop-scale choruses
- Enemy of the brand: polished, placeless pop that could come from anywhere
- Proof points: album craft, award nominations, in-house production, real locations
- Guard rail: never trade lyric detail for a trend hook — the detail is the moat

Six tactics, matched to how rap actually travels

TIKTOK · OWNED

Open Verse Challenge

- Release the single instrumental and invite verses
- Prize: a 7H studio day plus a feature slot
- Judge on bars, not on follower count

YOUTUBE · RETENTION

YouTube freestyle hub

- Two uploads a week: freestyle takes and bar breakdowns
- One “how I wrote it” video a month
- Lyric captions on every video for the diaspora

STREAMING

DSP editorial strategy

- Pitch 30 days ahead to Spotify and Apple
- Target rap and Afro-pop lists, not “Afro”
- Audiomack push for Uganda discovery

RADIO · TV

Radio that respects the genre

- Clean edits of “KAMPALA” and the focus single
- In-studio verses, never acoustic reworks
- XFM, Capital, NRG and KIIS drive-time

EAST AFRICA

Regional remix

- A Nairobi or Dar es Salaam vocalist on the remix
- One verse, one video, promotion split by market
- Cost shared; reach doubled

REVENUE

Live & merch conversion

- One headline showcase, filmed for later release
- Merch table and pre-order at the door
- Wristpiece as entry price, tee as the margin item

Three phases, one continuous story

WEEKS 1-4

Foundation & award season

Fix the record, own the narrative, convert nomination attention into an owned audience.

WEEKS 5-8

Focus single & regional surge

Drop the focus single and remix, own radio and TikTok, and push into East Africa.

WEEKS 9-12

Live, merch & monetisation

Convert attention into cash and into a repeatable live product.

WEEK	FOCUS	KEY DELIVERABLES	OWNER
1	Baseline & assets	Week 0 dashboard; clean edits; press kit rewritten as Afro-pop/rap	7H mgmt
2	Award-season push	Nomination content series; artist call-to-action; 10 press pitches	Marketing
3	Fan channel launch	WhatsApp channel + Telegram; unreleased verse as sign-up reward	Marketing
4	Radio & DJ seeding	Promo pack to 30+ DJs; drive-time bookings; instrumental live	Radio plugger
5	FOCUS SINGLE DROP	Release single + video; DSP editorial live; creator seeding	All
6	TikTok surge	Open Verse Challenge scaled; 20 creators briefed; winner announced	Content
7	Regional remix	Record and clear the East African remix; partner promo begins	A&R
8	Catalogue revival	Freestyle series peaks; older singles re-pitched to playlists	Content
9	Deluxe drop	Deluxe edition of Chapters I Never Wrote plus two new tracks	All
10	Merch drop	Wristpiece, cap and tee capsule; pop-up in Kampala	Ops
11	Headline showcase	Ticketed live show, filmed for release; industry guest list	Live
12	Audit & next cycle	Full KPI review; festival and brand pitches; next 12-week brief	7H mgmt

Convert the nomination into an audience we own

FIX THE RECORD

Week 1 · Reset the assets

- Build the Week 0 baseline: streams, saves, listeners, followers
- Rewrite bio and press kit as Afro-pop / rap — drop every acoustic claim
- Order clean edits and a radio master of “KAMPALA”

ATTENTION

Week 2 · Award-season content

- Seven-day content series on both nominations
- Artist-voiced ask: vote, then pass it on
- Pitch the story to 10 Ugandan outlets

OWNERSHIP

Week 3 · Owned channel

- Launch WhatsApp channel and Telegram room with one clear promise
- Sign-up reward: an unreleased verse, channel-first
- Target 1,200 members by end of week four

DISTRIBUTION

Week 4 · Radio & DJ seeding

- Clean edit, artwork and a one-line pitch
- 30+ East African DJs serviced one by one
- Five in-studio verse performances booked

DISCIPLINE

Phase gate: go / no-go

- Release only if: channel ≥ 1,200, four confirmed spins, video delivered
- Fail a gate and slip a week rather than spend cold

MEASURES

Success looks like

- Copy matches the music at last
- 1,200 owned fans before any paid spend
- Radio ready, not radio-hoping

One record, everywhere at once

LAUNCH

Week 5 · Release

- Focus single plus video on a Friday, with the channel told 48 hours early
- Editorial pitches already live; Audiomack and Spotify placements confirmed where possible
- Twenty creators seeded with the sound and a two-line brief

PARTICIPATION

Week 6 · Open Verse Challenge

- Instrumental released free; challenge duet format on TikTok
- Daily stitch of the best entries from the artist’s account
- Prize: 7H studio day plus a feature on the remix

EXPANSION

Week 7 · Regional remix

- Record the East African remix with a Nairobi or Dar-based vocalist
- Split promotion: each team owns its home market for one week
- Localise captions and slang per market — no copy-paste copy

CONSOLIDATION

Week 8 · Depth, not noise

- Winner announced; remix video shot
- Catalogue revival: older singles re-pitched with new artwork
- Two freestyle uploads a week continue without pause

Phase metric: 220,000 incremental streams, 2,500 owned fans, 12 radio spins a week, 1,500 challenge entries across TikTok and Instagram.

Turn momentum into money and a repeatable show

PRODUCT

Week 9 · Deluxe drop

- Chapters I Never Wrote (Deluxe): two new tracks plus the remix
- One new track is the live-set centrepiece
- Existing buyers get a first-listen link

REVENUE

Week 10 · Merch capsule

- Beaded wristpiece, camp cap, heavyweight tee, “Chapters” print
- One-weekend pop-up in Kamwokya or Ntinda
- UGX 55,000 tee · 25,000 wristpiece · 120,000 bundle

LIVE

Week 11 · Headline show

- 150-capacity venue; 120 tickets at UGX 38,000
- Set filmed for a week-12 live release
- Industry and brand guests seated, not backstage

Week 12 · Revenue reconciliation

LINE	UNITS	UNIT PRICE	GROSS
Merch — tees and caps	110	UGX 55,000	US$1,650
Merch — wristpieces	120	UGX 25,000	US$600
Showcase tickets	120	UGX 38,000	US$1,200
Streaming royalties	450,000 plays	blended	US$1,500

Then reinvest

- Roughly US$4,950 gross before costs — assume 45% margin after production, venue and media
- Hold 30% for the next single so the plan does not restart from zero
- Pitch festival and brand slots with the filmed live set and the KPI report
- Publish the audit internally: what moved, what did not, what changes next cycle

Targets are illustrative and must be re-based on the Week 0 dashboard.

SECTION 10 · RISK REGISTER

What could break this, and the answer to each

RISK	LIKELIHOOD	IMPACT	MITIGATION
Award nomination produces attention but no votes or buzz	Medium	Medium	Treat the nomination as content fuel, not the plan: every post still asks for a listen
Focus single underperforms in week one	Medium	High	Remix and deluxe are already funded; the campaign has three separate release moments
Rap framing alienates Afro-pop radio programmers	Low	High	Ship a sung-hook edit alongside the rap version; let programmers choose
Rival release saturates the same playlists	High	Medium	Own the owned channel first; playlist placement is upside, not the business model
Merch does not clear stock	Medium	Medium	Small run, pre-order model, bundle pricing, no cash outlay beyond 150 units
Streaming revenue disappoints	High	Low	Revenue plan leans on merch and live from day one; royalties are the residual

SECTION 11 · MEASUREMENT

One dashboard, reviewed every Monday

STREAMS

450K incremental

Weekly DSP pulls, split by track and territory

OWNED FANS

3,000 members

Channel size, open rate, 25% active target

RADIO

12 spins / week

Station logs plus DJ confirmation messages

ENGAGEMENT

1,500 entries

Open Verse submissions, saves and shares

REVENUE

US$4,950 gross

Merch, tickets and royalty statements

BRAND EQUITY

Unaided recall

Two quick fan polls at week 1 and week 12

Reporting cadence: Monday 30-minute review with 7H management; monthly one-page board note; week 12 written audit that becomes the input to the next cycle.

CLOSE · RECOMMENDATION

Stop describing him as a guitarist. Start selling the writing.

Baranga is an Afro-pop / rap artist with a nominated debut album, a 290,000-stream single and a label that can produce in-house. The strategy that follows from that is narrower, cheaper and far more defensible than the one that follows from an acoustic-soul profile.

NOW

Approve the corrected positioning and rewrite all public bios

WEEKS 1-2

Baseline dashboard, asset reset, award-season content live

WEEKS 3-4

Owned channel to 1,200 fans; radio and DJ pack out

WEEK 5

Focus single release — no earlier, no later

THE ONE-LINE BRIEF

“He tells Kampala’s story in bars, and makes it sing.”

Sources: 7H Music Group roster data, 7H Music Blog (Oct–Nov 2026), Apple Music and Spotify catalogue, UG Hip Hop Awards 2026 nomination material.